see the Chinese, who having occupied Dumchole at night, were preparing their defences across th12/26/2015e Indus from Koyle and Fukche. Accordingly, Grewal ordered Banon to fall back on Dungti and concentrate on its defences. The orders for the 70 Brigade commander were clear; there would be no further fallback from Dungti. There would be no further activity on the part of the Chinese in this sector, who also stayed clear of the Hanle region.

THE BATTLE OF REZANG-LA

By the middle of November, feverish Chinese activity in the Chushul sector indicated that an attack was eminent. Yula III, the northernmost Indian position on the Rezang Range was being held by two platoons of 1 Jat's Delta Company, the third platoon being deployed on the Tokung Ridge along with a section each of MMGs and 3-inch mortars. Bravo Company of 1/8 GR had a platoon each on Gurung, Trench and Foot Hills while Alpha and Charlie Company were deployed around the airfield, primarily guarding it from being attacked through the Spanggur Gap. Paw Hill was with Bravo Company of 13 Kumaon who also had a detachment from the Jats, a section manning 3-inch mortars and two RCL guns; Mugger Hill was with the Kumaoni Delta Company while Rezang-la was with the battalion's Charlie Company. In addition, there was a platoon of 5 Jat at Tsaka-la which was attached to 7 J&K Militia under 70 Infantry Brigade. Similarly, to the north, Nullah Junction, Hot Springs, Lukung and Phobrang were being held by 5 Jat, its men having recovered sufficiently from the fighting in the DBO Sector in early October.

At the end of the first phase of fighting, the Chinese declaration on Peking Radio that their next aim was to capture the Chushul airfield was, in all probability, a red herring. Peking had until then never staked a claim on Chushul. However, leaving the Indians in control of both the Rezang Ridge and the Gurung Hill feature would mean letting them dominate the Spanggur Sector. As it were, Indian posts on both Rezang-la and Gurung Hill were on the Spanggur side of the watershed. By forcing the Indians to defend the Spanggur Gap and the airfield as well, not only did the Chinese split Raina's forces, they also took the attention away from their actual objectives—Rezang-la and the crest of Gurung Hill.

Apart from diverting attention from their immediate strategic objectives, the Chinese announcement also implied that the PLA would have no